



Practice standing correctly every day and you will see the benefits in no time. A good time to practice is while you are brushing your teeth in the morning in front of the mirror. Stand with your feet hip-width apart and parallel to each other. Make sure your weight is evenly distributed between your feet. Rock slightly forward and back on your toes and ankles. You want to settle your weight slightly in front of your ankles. Your knees should be soft and never locked. Your hip bones should be even—check they are not tilted to one side or the other—and your tailbone should be lengthening toward the ground. Lift your abdominal muscles and your head up toward the ceiling. Think of your shoulders as open and relaxed. Envisage a plumb line straight from the top of your ear and through the middle of your shoulder, hip, knee and ankle.

Get used to this feeling and, as you go on with your everyday life, try to check from time to time how you are standing. Keep that awareness when sitting, too, making sure that your head and abs are lifting and that your shoulders are open.

Correct posture and alignment are essential in preventing lower back pain. By pulling in the abdominal muscles, pressure is taken off the lower back.

>> **benefits** of aerobic exercise

- **Reduces** the risk of heart disease, diabetes, and other diseases
- **Helps** weight loss
- **Improves** the metabolism
- **Strengthens** the heart
- **Lowers** the resting heart rate, which means your heart does not have to work as hard to pump blood around your body
- **Increases** the body's ability to use oxygen more efficiently and so burn fat faster
- **Decreases** stress levels